

FREE AND OPEN SOURCE PCB DESIGN AND LAYOUT TOOLS

Here are a few websites that provide you Free and Open Source PCB design and layout tools to help you get started fast!

gEDA

gEDA (which stands for general public licence (GPL) electronic design automation) is a collection of GPL tools for schematic capture, netlist export, design simulation, board layout, PCB design, and anything else which an EDA toolset needs to include. The tools involved in the suite enable you to create up to eight-layer PCBs with an unlimited number of components and net.

A part of the gEDA website is dedicated to documentation contributed by a multitude of authors, including users. It is a resource where you can find informal FAQs, HOW TOs, and tips/tricks to help you with the practical details of using the gEDA Suite.



URL: <http://geda.seul.org/wiki/>



KiCad EDA Suite

The KiCad EDA Suite project aims at creating a portable, cross-platform, Free/Libre/Open Source EDA suite that is capable of schematic and PCB design. The code is licensed under the terms of the GNU GPL and the application is designed to work on Microsoft Windows, Mac OS X and Linux. The website is divided into different sections that cover everything related to the software. It includes links to complete documentation and development resource. It also directs you to user and developer mailing list where you can interact with the community.

URL: http://kicad.sourceforge.net/wiki/Main_Page

FreePCB

FreePCB is an easy-to-learn and easy-to-use Open Source PCB editor for Microsoft Windows with the capability of professional-quality work. It supports one to sixteen copper layers and board size up to 152.4x152.4 cm². The website's homepage includes links to download, user guide, useful resource and user forum. The user forum has around 1243 registered users. The discussions on the forum includes ideas for new features and bug reports.



URL: www.freepcb.com



TinyCAD

TinyCAD is an application for drawing circuit diagrams commonly known as schematic drawings. It supports standard and custom symbol libraries. It also supports PCB layout programs with several netlist formats and can also produce SPICE simulation netlists. It is an Open Source application that runs on MS Windows. The site has links to downloads and other resource related to TinyCAD. It also has a user group with approximately 3000 users to get help on using TinyCAD.

URL: <http://sourceforge.net/apps/mediawiki/tinycad/index.php?title=TinyCAD>

PCB

PCB is an Open Source application for designing and editing PCBs Unix, Linux, Windows and Mac-based systems. It offers high-end features like an auto-router and trace optimiser, which can reduce layout time. The website has links to the manual of PCB, which is available in HTML and PDF formats. Along with the download link, it also points to the shared gEDA community mailing list and IRC Channel where one can get help for installing and using PCB.



URL: <http://pcb.gpleda.org/>